

PROVIDER-SPECIFIC AMENDMENT/RIDER

Issued by: BlueCross BlueShield of North Carolina (hereinafter "BCBSNC") **Effective Date:** January 1, 2025 **Amendment Reference No.:** AMND-2025-04-021 **Amends Group Policy No.:** GP-88239 **Amends Document ID:** w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018 **Amended Section:** Definitions and General Provisions **Provider Group:** Summit Health Partners (hereinafter "Provider Group" or "Medical Group")

This Provider-Specific Amendment/Rider (hereinafter "Rider") is made a part of the Group Master Contract and the referenced policy document(s). It modifies certain coverage terms, cost-sharing amounts, and definitions set forth in the policy document identified above. Capitalized terms used but not defined herein shall have the meanings assigned in the original policy. All provisions of the original policy not expressly amended by this Rider remain in full force and effect.

SECTION 1 - AMENDMENT SCOPE AND EFFECTIVE DATE

1.1 Purpose and Scope

This Rider is issued to reflect negotiated changes between BCBSNC and Summit Health Partners governing health benefit coverage for Members enrolled under Group Policy No. GP-88239. The modifications set forth in this Rider are effective for claims with dates of service on or after the Effective Date shown above. Any service rendered prior to the Effective Date shall be adjudicated in accordance with the policy provisions in effect at the time of service.

The modifications described herein are binding on BCBSNC, the Provider Group, and all enrolled Members. To the extent that any provision of this Rider conflicts with the original policy, the Rider shall control. This Rider supersedes any prior verbal or written agreements, representations, or side letters concerning the subject matter herein.

1.2 Plan Year and Renewal

For purposes of deductible, out-of-pocket maximum, and visit limits, the plan year is defined as the twelve-month period beginning on January 1 and ending on December 31 of each year. The coverage terms and cost-sharing amounts specified in Section 2 shall be recalculated at the start of each plan year. BCBSNC reserves the right to adjust premium rates at renewal consistent with applicable regulations and contractual notice requirements.

1.3 Members Affected

This Rider applies to all active, full-time employees of Summit Health Partners and their eligible dependents who are enrolled in the "PPO Comprehensive 2500" plan design and who primarily receive services from the Provider Group's employed or contracted network. Members utilizing out-of-network benefits are subject to the terms defined in Section 2.7.

1.4 Construction and Severability

Should any part of this Rider be determined invalid or unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in effect. The headings and subheadings are for convenience only and do not form a part of this Rider's substantive terms.

SECTION 2 - MODIFIED COVERAGE TERMS

The following amended terms replace the corresponding provisions in the original policy document w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018, specifically under "Definitions and General Provisions" and any other sections that reference the specified cost-sharing amounts or coverage limits.

2.1 In-Network Deductible

The in-network deductible for covered services is **\$1,200** per Member per calendar year. For family coverage, the aggregate family deductible is two times the individual deductible. The deductible applies to most covered services except preventive care as defined under the Affordable Care Act and the specific copayment-based services identified in Section 2.4, 2.5, and 2.6.

2.2 Out-of-Pocket Maximum

The annual out-of-pocket maximum for in-network covered services shall be **\$5,800** per Member. After a Member's eligible in-network cost-sharing payments (deductible, copayments, and coinsurance) reach \$5,800 in a plan year, BCBSNC pays 100% of the allowed amount for all covered in-network services for the remainder of that plan year. This limit does not include premiums, balance-billed amounts by non-participating providers, or charges for non-covered services.

2.3 Emergency Room Copayment

For treatment of a medical emergency in a hospital emergency room, the copayment is **\$200** per visit. This copayment is waived if the Member is directly admitted to the hospital as an inpatient from the emergency room. The emergency room copayment applies in addition to any deductible, but counts toward the out-of-pocket maximum.

2.4 MRI and Advanced Imaging Services

mri_prior_auth: Not required for in-network. Prior authorization for magnetic resonance imaging (MRI), magnetic resonance angiography (MRA), computed tomography (CT), and positron emission tomography (PET) scans is not required for in-network services when the service is performed at a freestanding imaging center or hospital outpatient department that participates in the BCBSNC network. For out-of-network imaging, standard prior authorization requirements as outlined in Section 7.3 of the original policy remain in effect. Members are encouraged to use in-network facilities to avoid unexpected balance billing.

2.5 Mental Health and Substance Use Disorder Outpatient Visits

Covered outpatient mental health and substance use disorder office visits are limited to **30/year, \$35 copay**. This benefit includes individual and group psychotherapy, medication management, and intensive outpatient program services when provided by a licensed behavioral health professional. The thirty-visit limit is combined across all in-network outpatient mental health and substance use disorder visits. If additional visits are medically necessary, the Provider Group must submit a treatment plan and obtain prior authorization. The copay of \$35 per visit does not apply to the deductible, but accumulates toward the out-of-pocket maximum.

2.6 Pre-Existing Condition Waiting Period

The waiting period for pre-existing conditions is **None**. No pre-existing condition exclusion or waiting period applies to any covered service under this Rider. Benefits are payable from the Member's effective date of coverage for all medically necessary services, regardless of whether the condition was present before enrollment.

2.7 Out-of-Network Coverage

Out-of-network coverage: **70% after \$2,500 deductible**. For covered services received from non-participating providers, BCBSNC reimburses 70% of the usual, customary, and reasonable (UCR) charge or the Medicare-based fee schedule amount, whichever is less, after the Member satisfies a separate out-of-network deductible of \$2,500 per plan year. The Member is responsible for the deductible, the remaining 30% coinsurance, and any charges that exceed the allowed amount (balance billing). No out-of-pocket maximum applies to out-of-network cost-sharing. Certain services, such as emergency care, are paid at in-network levels regardless of network status.

2.8 Prescription Drug Coverage Tiers

The plan provides a **4 tiers** formulary structure. Prescription copayment or coinsurance amounts are determined by the tier to which the medication is assigned on the BCBSNC Preferred Drug List. The tier definitions and applicable cost-sharing for a 30-day supply at a participating retail pharmacy are as follows:

Tier	Category	Member Cost Share (30-day retail)
1	Preferred Generics	\$10 copay
2	Non-Preferred Generics	\$30 copay
3	Preferred Brand-Name Drugs	\$60 copay
4	Non-Preferred Brand & Specialty	30% coinsurance (max \$250)

A 90-day supply of maintenance medications is available through the BCBSNC mail-order pharmacy at twice the retail copayment. Specialty medications classified in Tier 4 are subject to a separate specialty copayment accumulator and may require utilization management. The prescription drug out-of-pocket maximum is integrated with the medical out-of-pocket maximum of \$5,800.

2.9 Scope of Benefit Modifications

Except as expressly modified above, all other coverage terms, benefit maximums, medical necessity criteria, and exclusions set forth in the original policy document w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018 remain unchanged and are hereby reaffirmed.

SECTION 3 - SUPERSEDED PROVISIONS

3.1 Identification of Superseded Sections

The provisions of the original policy document identified as "Definitions and General Provisions" are superseded in their entirety with respect to the Members covered under this Rider. The following table provides a cross-reference of the original subsections that are replaced by this Rider's terms. Any references elsewhere in the policy to the old definitions shall now be read to incorporate the amended definitions below.

Original Policy Section (w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018)	Original Provision	New Provision (this Rider)	Effective Date
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Article I, Section 1.2 - "Deductible"	\$1,500 Individual / \$3,000 Family	\$1,200 Individual (Section 2.1)	1/1/2025
Article I, Section 1.4 - "Out-of-Pocket Maximum"	\$6,350 Individual / \$12,700 Family	\$5,800 Individual (Section 2.2)	1/1/2025
Article I, Section 1.7 - "Emergency Services Copayment"	\$250 per visit	\$200 per visit (Section 2.3)	1/1/2025
Article II, Section 2.9 - "Advanced Imaging Prior Authorization"	Required for all settings	Not required for in-network (Section 2.4)	1/1/2025
Article III, Section 3.5 - "Outpatient Mental Health Visits"	20 visits per year / \$40 copay	30/year, \$35 copay (Section 2.5)	1/1/2025
Article IV, Section 4.1 - "Pre-Existing Condition Limitation"	6-month waiting period	None (Section 2.6)	1/1/2025
Article V, Section 5.3 - "Out-of-Network Benefits"	60% after \$3,000 deductible	70% after \$2,500 deductible (Section 2.7)	1/1/2025
Article VI, Section 6.2 - "Prescription Drug Cost-Sharing"	3 tiers (Generics, Preferred Brand, Non-Preferred)	4 tiers (Section 2.8)	1/1/2025

3.2 Effect on Other Policy Provisions

All cross-references to the deductible, out-of-pocket maximum, or visit limits contained in other sections of the policy (e.g., benefit summaries, schedule of benefits, and explanation of coverage) are automatically updated to reflect the values stated in this Rider. No separate endorsement or rider is required to implement these changes.

3.3 Reservation of Rights

BCBSNC and Summit Health Partners reserve the right to mutually agree to future amendments to this Rider by a written instrument signed by both parties. This Rider does not alter the plan's right to modify premiums, terminate coverage, or change benefits upon renewal in accordance with the group contract and applicable law, provided that the terms set forth herein shall remain in effect through the current contract period ending December 31, 2025, unless otherwise agreed.

3.4 Entire Agreement

This Rider, together with the original policy document w14_bluecross_blueshield_detailed_policy_018 and all applicable Schedule of Benefits pages, constitutes the entire agreement between BCBSNC, the Provider Group, and the Members with respect to the coverage terms described herein. In the event of any inconsistency, the terms of this Rider shall govern for the Members enrolled under Group Policy No. GP-88239.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties have caused this Rider to be executed as of the Effective Date.

BlueCross BlueShield of North Carolina By: _____ Title:

Summit Health Partners By: _____ Title: